MICHAL LURIA, Ph.D. | Senior Human-Centered Researcher

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SUMMARY

Senior Researcher with over a decade of experience directing research and translating empirical findings into policy and industry impact. Active participant in policy forums, regulatory comment submissions, and regular contributor to leading media outlets. Skilled in designing rigorous studies, establishing ethical frameworks, and convening interdisciplinary stakeholders across civil society, academia, government, and industry to advance evidence-based policymaking on AI systems and platform safety.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Fellow / 2021 – current / Center for Democracy & Technology

- Directed research programs on emerging technologies at the intersection of media, technology, and democracy, with particular focus on AI systems, platform accountability, and child safety online.
- Built and led interdisciplinary research teams (10+ researchers and coders) designing and executing large-scale qualitative and mixed-methods studies; managed research operations, rigor, and timelines across multiple concurrent projects.
- Established research ethics protocols and data management frameworks for sensitive datasets and human subjects research, including work involving minors; ensured compliance with institutional review standards.
- Translated empirical research into policy and public impact output through the submission of regulatory comments, op-eds in major outlets (CNN, Wired, Tech Policy Press), and strategic partnerships with civil society, academic institutions, and industry.
- Supervised and mentored research interns, externs, and junior researchers, providing methodological, ethical, and professional development guidance.

Research Assistant / 2016 – 2021 / Human-Computer Interaction / CMU

- As a Ph.D. candidate, managed large and inter-disciplinary research teams focused on chatbots and social agents, using participatory design, interviews, surveys, ethnography, and more.
- Published 20+ peer-reviewed papers in top-tier venues (ACM CHI, DIS, HRI), including several best paper and honorable mention awards.

Head of Product / 2014 – 2015 / Hippotec ltd.

Led strategy and team management for the product team in a full-cycle mobile app development firm; defining product vision, overseeing user experience research, and coordinating the team.

Project Manager / 2010 – 2012 / StyleRiver Fashion E-commerce

Managed cross-functional projects for a pioneering fashion e-commerce platform, overseeing product, operations, and special initiatives including press, marketing and advertising.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Human-Computer Interaction / 2021 / CMU
Dissertation: Designing Interpersonal Intelligence and Ownership Models for Social Agents
M.Sc. in Human-Computer Interaction / 2018 / CMU
B.A. in Interactive Communication / 2015 / Reichman University

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

(Full list available upon request or via Google Scholar)

Selected Reports & Papers

- Dark Patterns in AI Chatbots: A Taxonomy to Inform Better Design / CDT, 2026
- What Kids and Parents Want: Policy Insights for Social Media Safety Features / CDT, 2025
- The Kids Are Online: Research-Driven Insights on Child Safety Policy / CDT, 2025
- Screened Out: The Impact of Digitized Hiring Assessments on Disabled Workers / CHI, 2026
- Co-Design Perspectives on Algorithm Transparency Reporting / ACM FAccT, 2023
- Letters from the Future: Exploring Ethical Dilemmas in the Design of Social Agents / CHI, 2022

Selected Op-eds

- When Kids Outsmart Gates: Why Online Age Restrictions Backfire / MIT Tech Review, 2026
- Restricting and monitoring social media won't protect kids — here's what will / CNN, 2024
- AI Chatbots Are Emotionally Deceptive by Design / Tech Policy Press, 2025
- Your ChatGPT Relationship Status Shouldn't Be Complicated / Wired, 2023

RECENT ADVISORY SERVICE & TECH POLICY ENGAGEMENTS

Problematic Use Metrics Expert Working Group / Knight-Georgetown Institute / 2026
Expert Working Group on Teens, AI and Emotional Dependence / Microsoft / 2026
Psychosocial Reliability Benchmark Task Force / MLCommons / 2026
Public Technology Leadership Collaborative on Chatbot Design / Data & Society / 2026
Advisory Group for Meta Community Forums / Meta / 2025
Testimony before the Colorado Senate Judiciary Committee on social media protections / 2025
Submitted comments to NTIA on ethical guidelines for research using pervasive data / 2025
Contributed to congressional testimony on protecting children and teens online / 2025

SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

Communicator Award of Distinction — Causes & Awareness: "More Tools, More Control" / 2025
Communicator Award of Distinction — Causes & Awareness: "Screened Out" / 2025
Anthem Award, Human & Civil Rights — Best Use of Data / 2023
Best Paper & Honorable Mentions, ACM DIS and HRI Conferences
CRA-W Graduate Cohort for Women / 2019
Cadence Women in Tech Scholarship / 2018

SELECTED ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Full Paper Track Chair / ACM CUI Conference / 2026
Program Associate Chair / ACM FAccT Conference / 2025 – 2027
Program Associate Chair / ACM DIS Conference / 2023 – 2025
Founder / Speculative Futures Chapter TLV / 2021-2023
Session Chair / RightsCon Conference Sessions / 2023